

# Compsognathids

When most people think of a dinosaur they imagine something huge and fierce like *Tyrannosaurus*, with its teeth bared, ready to kill. But some members of the compsognathid family were no bigger than chickens. The compsognathids were nimble little predators that hunted small animals. They were related to the ancestors of birds and probably had simple, fuzzy feathers to keep their small bodies warm.



## FAMILY FACT FILE

### Key features

- Small, lightweight bodies with hollow bones
- Skin covered with scales or furry feathers
- Long tails used for balance

### When

Compsognathids first appeared in the Late Jurassic, 151 million years ago. They died out in the Early Cretaceous, 108 million years ago.